



Making the next right action obvious, for the people doing the work and the people leading it.

If you only see one slide

- 1 People don't need a longer list. They need to know what to do first, and why.
- 2 We sort work into three groups by time, show one task at the top, and explain every rank in plain words.
- 3 Managers see the same work, so they can spot risk and move work. They never see a stopwatch on people.

Two complaints, one screen

I never know what needs my attention first.

WORKERS

I cannot see what each worker is doing.

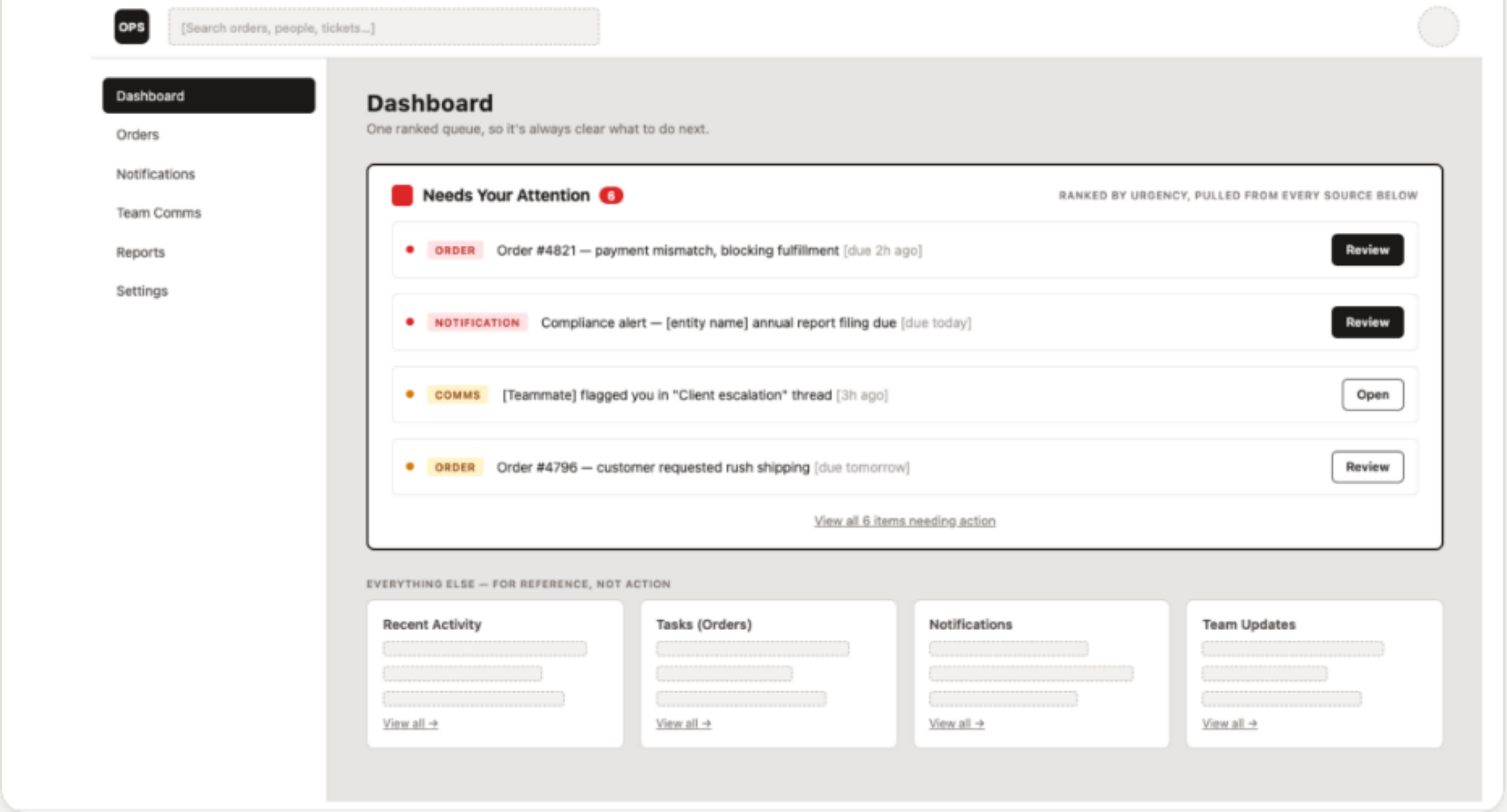
MANAGERS

The challenge asks us to rank individual work from most critical to least urgent.

It already has a ranked list

Currently, the dashboard shows:

- Recent activity /Tasks (Orders) /Notifications /Team updates (Internal Comms)



- 1 Ranked by urgency, but it never says why.
- 2 Every row is labeled by where it came from.
- 3 Four equal cards below repeat the same work.

Sorting is not the same as knowing what to do.

Five reasons people still feel lost

No reason. The list is ranked, but nobody can see why, so nobody trusts it.

Wrong labels. Order, Notification, and Comms say where work came from, not what happens if you ignore it.

No first thing. Four rows, four equal buttons.

No finish line. Work disappears silently. There is no done.

Nothing for managers. They walk the floor and ask.

Two people, one shift

Priya Raman. Outbound Exception Coordinator.

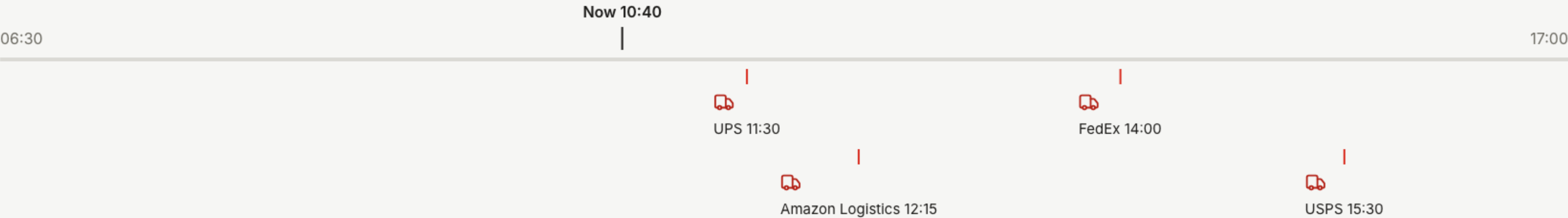
Fixes the problems that stop orders reaching a truck. Works at a shared desk by the dock, interrupted every few minutes.

Danielle Okafor. Shift Operations Manager.

Seven people. Lives on the floor, checks the screen in thirty second glances.

Out of scope for now: pickers and packers. Their scanners already give them one task at a time.

In fulfillment, trucks set the deadlines



A truck does not wait. Missing it means a whole wave of customers gets their orders late.

What we assumed, and how we would check

The fulfillment team in the brief is desk based exception coordinators and their shift manager.	Assumed	Shadow two coordinators for a full shift.
Source systems can tell us the due time, the linked truck, and how many orders are blocked.	Assumed	Check the WMS and carrier feeds with engineering.
People mainly use a shared desktop, and read it from up to 2 meters away.	Assumed	Site visit and photos of workstations.
A coordinator handles 5 to 20 actionable items per shift.	Needs research	Pull one week of exception logs.
One shared priority model is acceptable to both workers and managers.	Needs research	Card sort and a ranking exercise with both groups.
Managers want to step in on exceptions, not watch people minute by minute.	Assumed	Manager interviews, plus a trust survey after the pilot.

Five rules we designed by

- 1 One thing first.
- 2 Always say why.
- 3 Group by time, not by source.
- 4 See the work, not the worker.
- 5 Undo instead of are you sure.

Every task lands in one of three groups



Do now

A truck, a person, or many orders are at risk.



Up next

Matters today. A clock is running.



Later today

Real work. Nobody is blocked yet.

For your info never enters the queue. It goes to Updates.

Four questions decide the order

How soon is it due?

How many orders are waiting on it?

Will customers feel it?

Is it about safety or the law?

Safety always goes first, no matter what the numbers say.

Same six tasks, different first move

Sorted by due time

- 1. Order 4821 payment mismatch (overdue since 08:40)
- 2. Reply to vendor about damaged tote count (10:45)
- 3. Danielle asked you to confirm the UPS order count (11:00)
- 4. Label printer offline at Pack 7 (11:30)
- 5. Lithium battery orders missing hazmat labels (11:45)
- 6. Rush shipping request on order 4796 (tomorrow)

Sorted by Relay

- 1. Label printer offline at Pack 7 (score 62, blocks 140 orders, UPS 11:30)
- 2. Lithium battery orders missing hazmat labels (61)
- 3. Order 4821 payment mismatch (50)
- 4. Reply to vendor about damaged tote count (36)
- 5. Danielle asked you to confirm the UPS order count (36)
- 6. Rush shipping request on order 4796 (12)

The printer is not due first, but it blocks 140 orders for the 11:30 truck. It should come first.

The shape of the answer

Nav	Good morning, name. n things need you.	Next trucks. Progress.
	Do this now. Why first: reason. [Start]	
	DO NOW	
	UP NEXT	
	LATER TODAY	

- 1 One task at the top, with the reason it is first.
- 2 Three groups, named by time.
- 3 A short reason on every row.
- 4 Trucks and progress on the side, never competing.

My work

Relay

My work

Team

Updates

Look up

My work

Good afternoon, Priya.

2 things need you now. 4 of 10 done today.

How we sort your work

DO THIS NOW 1 of 6

Due in 50 min

Label printer offline at Pack 7

Why first: 140 orders need labels before the UPS truck leaves at 11:30.

→ Next step: Reroute orders to Pack 9

@System · UPS Ground truck 11:30 · 140 orders waiting

Working on it · 16 min

Mark done

Ask for help

More

DO NOW 1

A truck, a person, or many orders are at risk.

Lithium battery orders missing hazmat labels

12 orders cannot ship legally

Due 11:45

Order

Start

UP NEXT 3

Matters today. A clock is running.

Order 4821 payment mismatch, held at pack

Overdue, 1 order waiting

Late by 2 h

Order

Start

Reply to vendor about damaged tote count

Due soon, nothing blocked

Due in 5 min

Message

Start

Danielle asked you to confirm the UPS order count

Danielle needs the count

Due in 20 min

Message

Start

Search orders, people, tickets

PR

NEXT TRUCKS

UPS Ground	11:30 · in 50 min	236 orders at risk
Amazon Logistics linehaul	12:15 · in 1 h 35 min	38 orders at risk
FedEx Express	14:00 · in 3 h 20 min	34 orders at risk
USPS	15:30 · in 4 h 50 min	On track

4 of 10 done

Shift ends 17:00

UPDATES

MC Door 14 loading resumed after a conveyor jam was cleared.

4 min ago

JW Reported a wet floor near Door 11 and blocked the lane.

9 min ago

Pack 7 printer has gone offline 3 times since 06:00.

20 min ago

See all updates

- 1 Do this now, and why.
- 2 Start tells the team what you are working on.
- 3 Only Do now is tinted red. Color stays rare, so it keeps its meaning.
- 4 The next trucks are always visible.

Finish one thing, the next one is ready

The hero, Mark done pressed

Done

The toast

Done. 5 of 10 done today. [Undo](#)

The next task in the hero

 **Lithium battery orders missing hazmat labels**

No confirm dialogs. Undo is always there for eight seconds.

Urgent work never jumps under your cursor

New and more urgent: Conveyor stopped at Pack 9 merge.

Show me Stay here

Label printer offline at Pack 7

If you are busy, we tell you and let you choose. If you are away, we move it to the top for you.

The manager's view, in shape

Do now	May need help	No owner	Next truck
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Person. Right now. Load.

Needs you. [Assign] [Check in]

- 1 Four numbers that matter right now.
- 2 What each person is working on.
- 3 What needs the manager, with one button each.

Team

Relay

My work

Team

Updates

Look up

Team

Day shift · Outbound · 5 working, 1 on break, 1 out today.

DO NOW ACROSS TEAM
4

MAY NEED HELP
1
Escalation: medical supplies order 4833...

NO OWNER
2
Kwame is out today

NEXT TRUCK
UPS
11:30

PERSON	RIGHT NOW	LOAD	ACTION
TN Tomasz Nowak Customer Escalations C...	Working on: Escalati...	May need help Light	See work
PR Priya Raman Outbound Exception Co...	Working on: Label printer o...	Busy	See work
JW Jordan Whitfield Safety and Compliance ...	Working on: Wet floor on f...	Light	See work
LH Luis Herrera Inventory Control Coor...	Working on: Count mismat...	Light	See work
MC Mei Lin Chen Transportation Coordin...	Working on: UPS trailer at ...	Light	See work
AB Aisha Bello Problem Solve Lead	On break	Light	See work
KA Kwame Asante Outbound Exception Co...	Out today	Light	See work

NEEDS YOU

Escalation: medical supplies order 4833 not shipped. No update for 80 min.
Wrong item claim on order 4755. No owner. Due 15:00.
Oversize parcel needs a manual rate, order 4790. No owner. Due 11:20.

Check in
Assign
Assign

TRUCKS TODAY

UPS Ground
Amazon Logistics linehaul
FedEx Express
USPS

11:30 · in 50 min
236 orders at risk
12:15 · in 1 h 35 min
38 orders at risk
14:00 · in 3 h 20 min
34 orders at risk
15:30 · in 4 h 50 min
On track

- 1 Kwame is out, and two tasks have no owner.
- 2 Tomasz’s escalation has had no update for 80 minutes. It is flagged as may need help.
- 3 Assign in two clicks, with undo.
- 4 Each person’s load in words: light, busy, or full.

What managers see, and what they never see

We show

- What each person is working on
- Work that is late or has no owner
- Tasks that may need help
- Trucks at risk

We never show

- Idle time or time off task
- Keystrokes or screen activity
- Rankings of people
- Break timers

Everyone sees the same team board. Nothing about people is hidden from them.

Nothing was removed. It was sorted.

Tasks (Orders)	Ranked into My work. Source tag Order.
Notifications	Ranked into My work when they need action. Otherwise in Updates.
Team updates (Internal Comms)	Ranked into My work when someone asks you something. Otherwise in Updates.
Recent activity	Updates, under Activity. Never ranked.

What we chose, and what we gave up

We chose

Three simple groups

A rule we can explain in one sentence

One big task at the top

Work visibility for managers

A Start button

We gave up

Fine grained ranking of every item

The extra accuracy of machine learning, for now

Seeing more rows without scrolling

Minute by minute tracking of people

One extra click per task

Why it is worth it: people act faster on a list they understand and trust.

What could go wrong

Everything becomes Do now.	High thresholds. We flag anyone with more than three Do now tasks so the manager can rebalance.
People game the ranking.	Only set roles can escalate. Waiting needs a person and a time. Managers see overrides.
People stop trusting it.	Every rank has a reason. People can ask for help, say not mine, or hand off, and we review those signals weekly.
Data goes stale.	An updated time is always visible, with a warning when a feed is late.

EXTENSION: BEYOND THE ONE HOUR ASK

A four week pilot on one shift

5 min

Under 5 min to first action on Do now tasks

fewer

Fewer orders missing their truck because of an exception

10 min

Under 10 min for work with no owner to find one

10 s

Under 10 s for a manager to say what is at risk

Plus a short trust survey: do I understand why tasks are ranked, and do I feel watched?

A small system, built to stay calm

Color



Type

Page title

Row title

Body text

Every color has a job. Red appears only where something is truly at risk.

Components

Do now

Priority row

Toast

What we would build next

- 1 Shift handoff that writes itself, so nothing is lost at 17:00.
- 2 A handheld version for Problem Solve leads on the floor.
- 3 Pinning, once we know how people want to override the order.
- 4 Learning from overrides to tune the ranking every week.

Try it yourself

foundey-relay.vercel.app

Tip: open Prototype controls to switch between Priya and Danielle, send an urgent task, or see it in wireframe mode.

Design system: foundey-relay.vercel.app/system

